

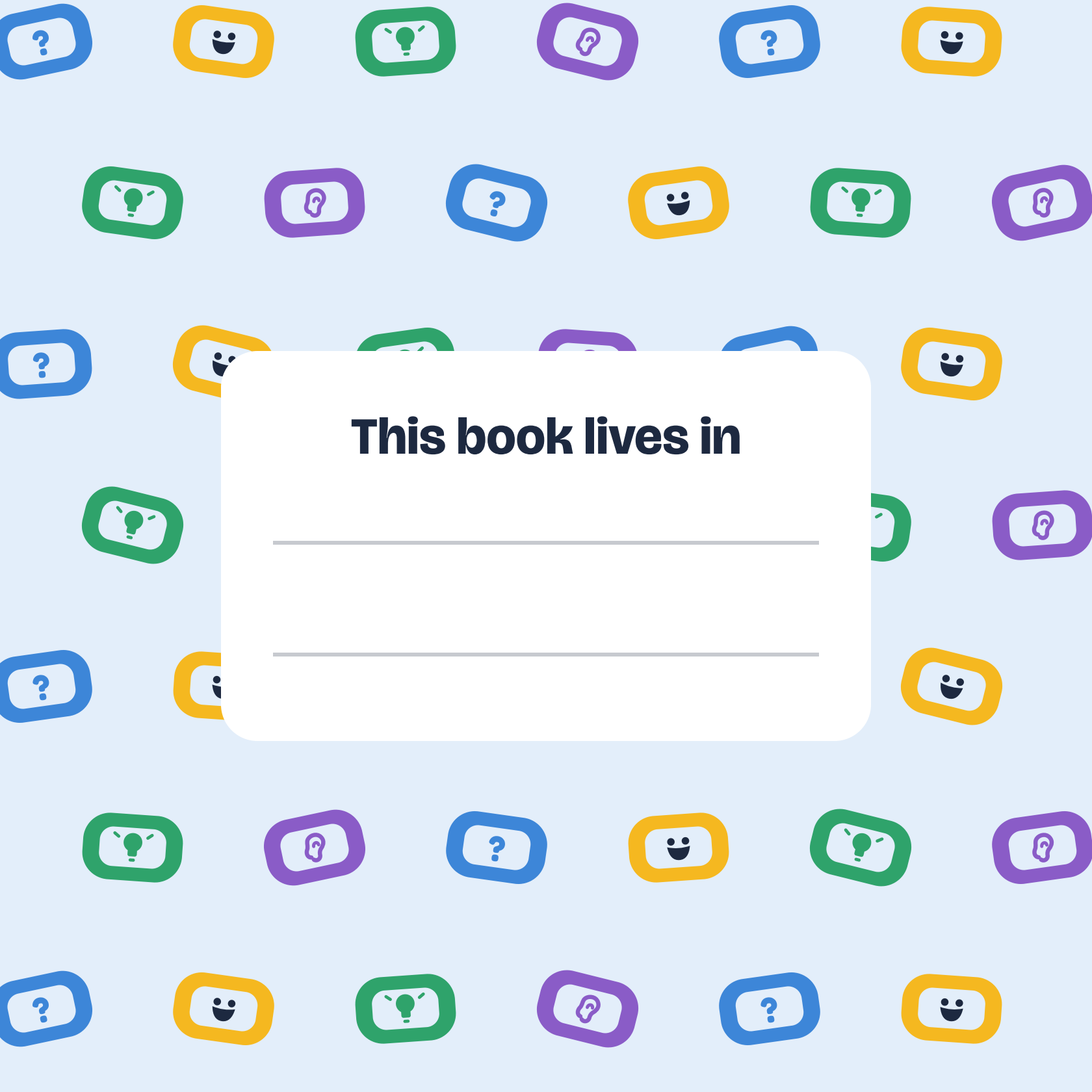
 Play Before Pixels

More Talk, Less Tap

**Circle-time
talk games
inside!**

An Add-One Chain story for circle time



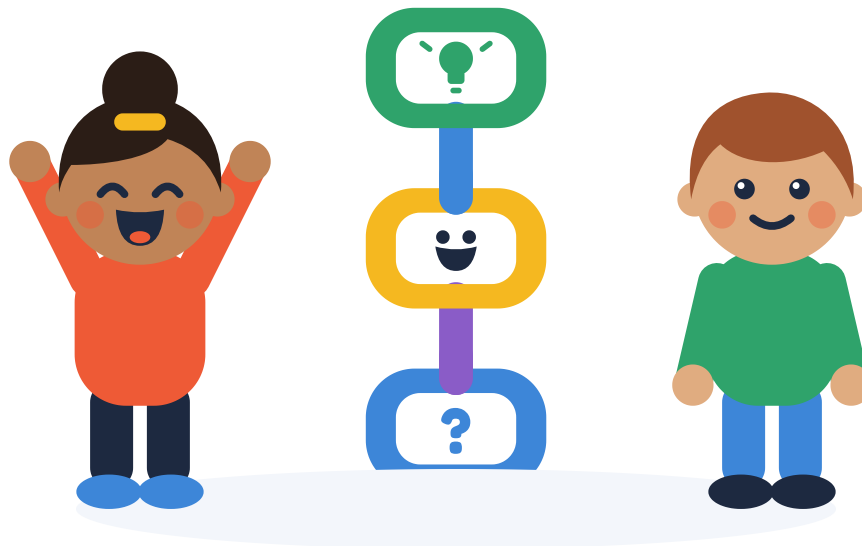


This book lives in

More Talk, Less Tap

An Add-One Chain story for circle time

Play Before Pixels



Play Before Pixels



More Talk, Less Tap

Bonus read-aloud edition, included with The Add-One Chain Classroom Game Kit

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This is a work of fiction. Room 5, Ms. Poppy and the children are imaginary and are not based on any real school, teacher or child. The games and notes at the back are general ideas for grown-ups to enjoy with children; they are not a program, assessment or professional advice. Adults supervise all activities. Keep tape and paper scraps away from children under 3, and with them nearby use only objects too big to fit through a toilet-paper tube (about 1.25 in / 3.2 cm). Hang a paper chain on the wall; it is never worn.

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Meet Room 5



Priya

asks the first question



Leo

knows a joke for
everything



Zara

is full of ideas



Milo

always wants to know
more



Sam

is a great listener



Ms. Poppy

is the teacher

In Room 5, lots of things went **tap**.

Tap, tap, tap went the rain on the window.

Tap, tap went Bubbles the fish, nosing the side of his bowl.



But at circle time, nobody said a word.

Not Priya. Not Leo. Not Zara, or Milo, or Sam.

Everybody was waiting for somebody else to go first.



So Ms. Poppy tipped out a big bin of paper loops.

SWOOSH!



“Let’s make an **Add-One Chain!**” she said. “Every time someone says something out loud, a link goes on.”



Ask a question

blue link



Tell a joke

yellow link



Share an idea

green link

Priya's hand shot up first.

Why is Bubbles
orange?



“That’s a question!” said Ms. Poppy.

A blue link went on the Add-One Chain.

Add-One Chain

LOOP!



Then Leo had a joke.

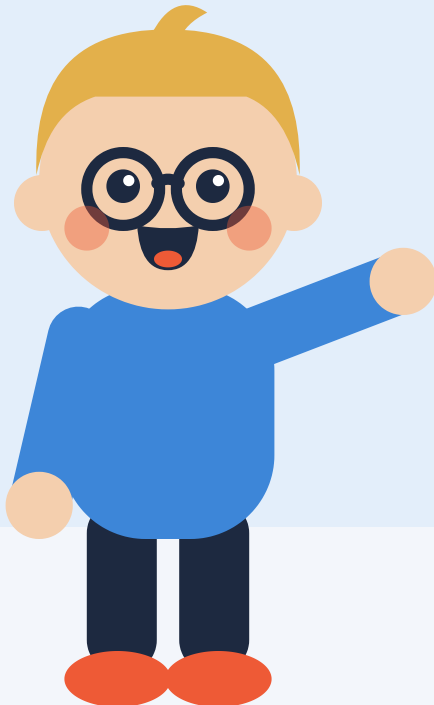
Knock, knock!

Who's there?

Cow says.

Cow says who?

No, silly! A cow says
MOO!



Room 5 laughed and laughed. Even Bubbles blew a bubble.

A yellow link went on.

LOOP!

On it goes!



Zara watched Bubbles swim round and round, all by himself.

I have an idea! Let's draw Bubbles some friends!



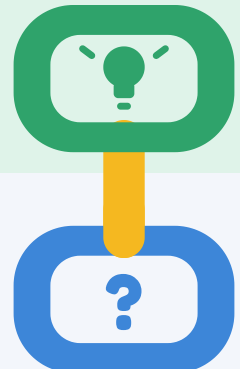


“That’s an idea!” said Ms. Poppy.

A green link went on.



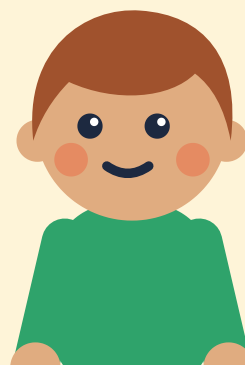
LOOP!



All week long, Room 5 talked. At snack time. At painting time. Out in the garden.

Why are bananas
bendy?

What if worms wore
tiny hats?



By Wednesday, the Add-One Chain was taller than everyone. Well, everyone except Ms. Poppy.

But Sam hadn't added a link yet. Sam liked listening best.



Then, on Thursday, everybody had something to say.

ALL. AT. ONCE!

Me! Me!

Guess what—

Listen—

My turn!

I know!



The words got all tangled up. Nobody could hear anybody. Everybody grabbed for the chain at once.

The Add-One Chain went wibble... wobble...



Links everywhere. Room 5 went very, very quiet.
Then a small voice said something.

Maybe... we could take
turns?



Everyone turned to look at Sam.

Sam, that's a great
idea!

Sam's very first link started a
brand-new chain.

LOOP!



Ms. Poppy brought out the Talking Star.

“Whoever holds the star gets a turn. Everybody else listens, in their own way.”



**Pass the star.
Take a turn.
Pass the star.
Take a turn.**

LOOP!

LOOP!

LOOP!



When it was Priya's turn, she talked about her grandma's garden. Milo listened to every word. Then he asked something more.

My grandma grows
giant pumpkins!



How do they get so
big?

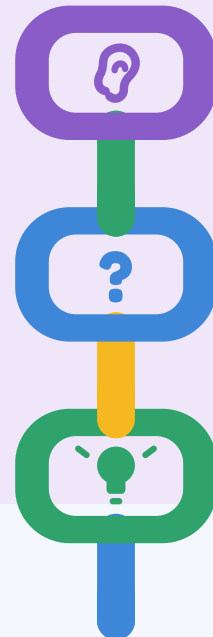


“Milo, you were really listening,” said Ms. Poppy.
“Listening counts too!”

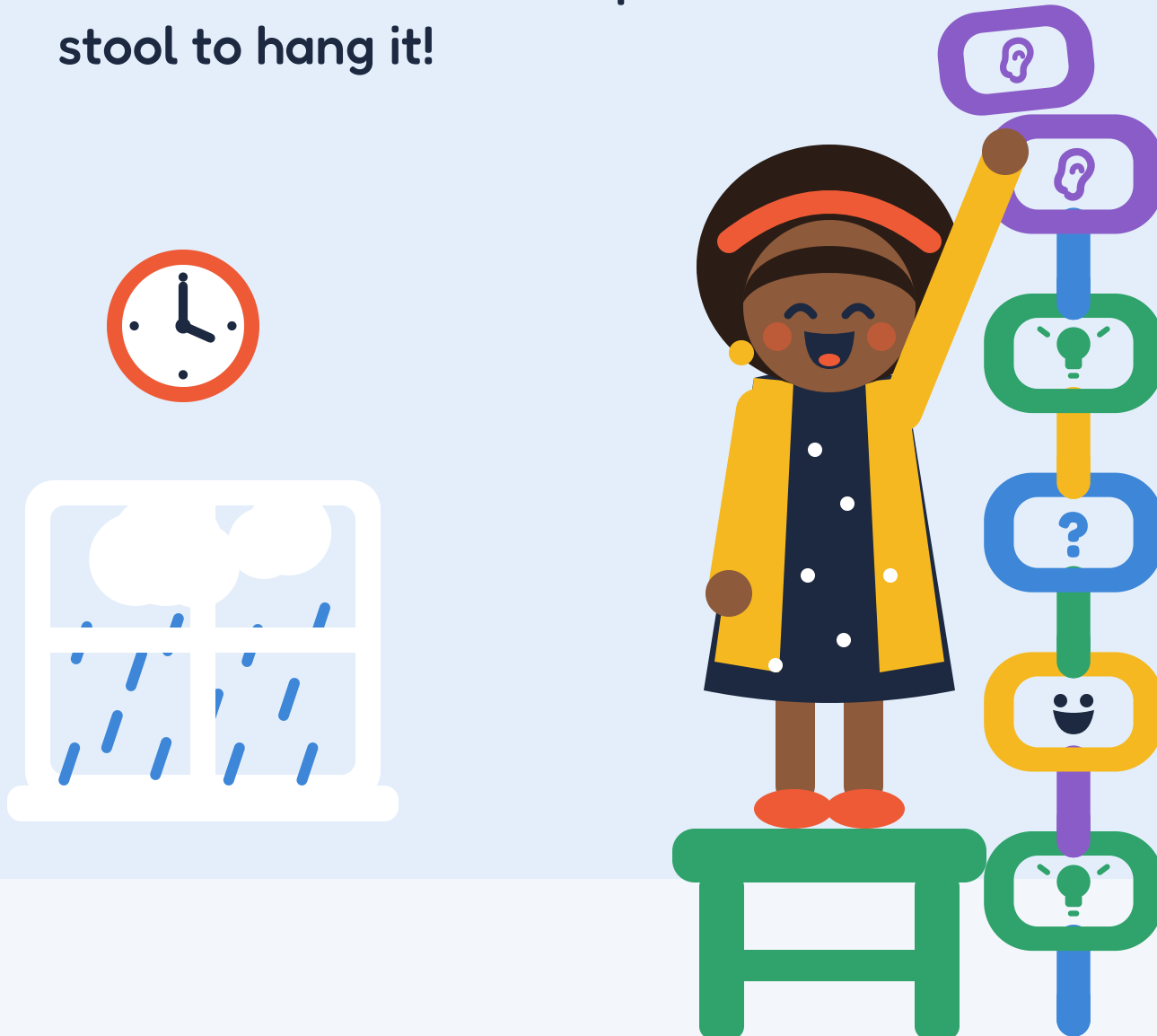
So the chain got a brand-new color: a purple link,
for good listening.



LOOP!



Up, up, up went the Add-
One Chain. Past the window.
Past the clock. Ms. Poppy
had to stand on the step
stool to hang it!



“We built all that with our words!” said Priya.

“And our ears,” said Sam.

Tap, tap, tap went the rain. But nobody in Room 5 heard it. They were much too busy talking.

The End



A note for educators and families

Children get better at conversation by having lots of conversations, with grown-ups and friends who listen and talk back. Every question and answer, every joke and laugh, is a turn. *More Talk, Less Tap* makes those turns visible, and celebrates them.

Make your own Add-One Chain. Paper strips and tape, sticky notes on a door or a row of drawings on a wall all work. Keep it a celebration, not a scoreboard: no winners, no prizes, and nobody has to talk until they are ready.

Try these at circle time

- **Pause and wait.** After you ask a question, count to five in your head. Quieter children, like Sam, often need that moment.
- **Say what you see.** “You’re smiling! Do you have a joke?”
- **Repeat and add a little.** “A pumpkin!” “A giant orange pumpkin!”
- **Follow their lead.** Talk about what the child already cares about.
- **Count listening too.** A follow-up question such as “What happened next?” shows real listening.

Every way of talking counts: words, signs, pointing or a tap on a talking device, in the language you know best. And when the chain tears? Start it again, one turn at a time.



Talk starters for your Add-One Chain



Questions

- What is the best smell in the world?
- If you were tiny, where would you go?
- What would a dog say if it could talk?



Jokes

- What do you call a sleeping dinosaur? A dino-snore!
- Why did the teddy bear skip dessert? It was stuffed!



Ideas

- Let's make up a song about lunch.
- Let's build a fort for the teddy bears.
- Let's invent a brand-new animal.



Listening

- What happened next?
- How did that feel?
- Can you tell me more?

Circle-time talk games

Three quick games for ages 3–7. A grown-up leads, everyone gets a turn, and every voice counts.

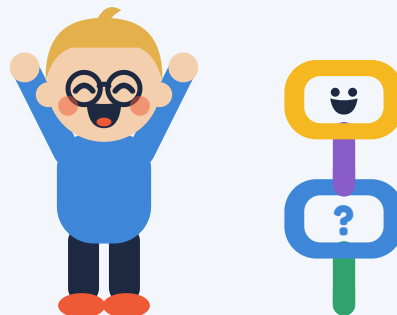


Make an Add-One Chain

Whole group · 10 minutes

You need: Paper strips and tape (a grown-up does the taping)

1. Sit in a circle with the basket in the middle.
2. Each time someone asks a question, tells a joke or shares an idea, they add a link. Words, signs and pointing all count.
3. A follow-up question counts too!
4. How long can the chain grow before tidy-up time?



2

Pass the Talking Star

Whole group · 5–10 minutes

You need: Any soft toy to be your Talking Star

1. Give everyone the same starter, like “My favorite animal is...”
2. Whoever holds the star gets a turn. Everyone else listens.
3. Pass the star to the next friend.
4. Saying “pass” is always OK.

3

Ask Me One More

Pairs · 5 minutes

You need: Nothing at all

1. One friend shares something: “I have a cat.”
2. Their partner listens, then asks one more question: “What is its name?”
3. Swap turns.
4. Grown-ups, show it first with a child.

Room 5 is making a chain out of words.

Every time someone asks a question, tells a joke or shares an idea, a link goes on the Add-One Chain. But what happens when everybody talks at once?

A warm, funny read-aloud about conversation, taking turns and really listening, with circle-time talk games and a note for educators and families at the back.

Play Before Pixels

Ages 3–7 • Bonus read-aloud from The Add-One Chain Classroom Game Kit



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